

want a new outfit for the occasion (white suit?) and maybe a dinner party with some friends and family. I don't have a big family or a wide circle of close friends, so that's probably fifteen people at most. If I marry someone with a big family, that person is allowed to invite fifteen people too. Future spouse: Choose wisely! I'm gonna go ahead and say:

Money to save for my wedding: \$1,000 (But wait: How much do six dogs cost? I'm definitely going to have to reconsider this entire wedding budget. I'm gonna need more money.)

That's how I think about it now. But it's always possible that postproposal, into my thirties or forties, I could transform into a total animal and demand my white suit be Dior and my wedding take place on stage at Coachella while Chance the Rapper officiates.

HOW TO GO ON A FREE HONEYMOON (SORT OF)

I have a friend who is on her second marriage and still paying off her first wedding. This happens because couples usually underestimate the cost of their weddings (if they don't stick to a strict budget) by about \$15,000 to \$20,000, according to Chertoff. That's a *huge* number. So instead of taking out a loan, many people pay for their weddings on credit cards, which offer benefits for spending. (The Points Guy would love this!)

Mandi Woodruff, a finance reporter who cohosts *The Brown Ambition* podcast, paid for her entire honeymoon with credit card rewards points. She got the Chase Sapphire preferred card with the 50,000 point sign-up offer, a bonus contingent on being able to spend the allotted amount (\$3,000 to \$4,000) in the allotted time frame (three to four months). She knew the deposit for her chosen venue was \$3,000, so she thought, "I'm actually gonna be spending this money anyway," so why not get the benefits? But, she cautions, you should do this only if you're able to pay it back in the time frame you're given. The 0 percent interest rate lasts sometimes just six or twelve months, so you want to pay it all off before the new interest charges kick in. (If something happens and you can't pay it off